Development Institute, who tweeted the UP government's RFP advertisement on 10 September 2020, calling it 'ridiculous'. Similarly, Jairam Ramesh called it 'absolutely bogus' while former finance secretary Arvind Mayaram termed it 'simply delusional', https://twitter.com/EmergingRoy/status/1303897139173490688.

Roy had served as a member of the prime minister's Economic Advisory Council until September 2019. For a critique on the need for a strategic economic vision, as opposed to an administrative approach, see Rathin Roy's series in *Business Standard*, 'It's not too late, but soon it will be', *Business Standard*, 7 August 2020; 'Articulate an economic strategy', *Business Standard*, 8 May 2020. The UP government had called for bids for a global consultant on 19 June 2020, opened the financial bids on 27 November 2020 but cancelled the bid process on 22 March 2021, with a government statement saying that a 'fresh tender notice is likely in this regard'. Umesh Raghuvanshi, 'trillion dollar economy goal: 13 months on, Uttar Pradesh still weighing its options', *The Hindustan Times*, 26 July 2021, https://www.hindustantimes.com/cities/lucknow-news/trilliondollar-economy-goal-13-months-on-uttar-pradesh-still-weighing-its-options-101627322440496.html.

32. Initial details from UP government data note, 'Skill wise registrations and interests in employment', 6 May 2020. Updated UP government details on 15 September 2020 provided by Pravin Kumar.

33. P. Chidambaram, 'The worst effected economy', *The Indian Express*, 6 September 2020, https://indianexpress.com/article/opinion/columns/india-economy-slowdown-act-of-god-p-chidambaram-6584615/.

34. TNN, 'BJP wins 41 of 59 bypoll seats, 31 of them at expense of Congress', *The Times of India*, 11 November 2020, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/india/bjp-wins-41-out-of-59-bypoll-seats-31-at-congs-expense/articleshow/79158640.cms.

35. Narendra Modi's address at BJP office 11 November 2020. Full video available at: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nhtA2WyAQ9k.